

Kingdom of the Sun

Kingdom of the Sun · Media Production · How It Makes Money

Built 2026-06-01. This is BJ's operation to run and to monetize. The media production is his show. This maps the ways the operation eats, so the money model is deliberate, not an afterthought. Internal to BJ. Figures are his to set.

The frame

BJ runs the full media production for the Kingdom of the Sun: photography, video, the website, the content system, the archive. That's a real media operation with multiple ways to earn. The mistake would be to treat it as one flat photographer fee. It's a stack.

The revenue stack (six lines)

#	Line	Who pays	What it is
1	Production fee	The tournament / committee	A flat fee for running official media + the build, covering the December trip. The floor.
2	Photo sales	Players / families	Individual, team, and action photo packages, digital downloads + prints, from the galleries
3	Video packages	Players / families / teams	Highlight reels (recruiting tape), team hype videos, the championship recap
4	Sponsor media	Sponsors	Premium photo/video features as paid add-ons to sponsor tiers (not just free fulfillment)

#	Line	Who pays	What it is
5	Builder retainer	The tournament	The website + digital, annual, recurring
6	Licensing / archive	Press, teams, services, fans	Footage licensing, championship prints/posters, the program book (print + ad sales)

The insight: lines 2, 3, and 6 scale with the event's size and don't depend on the committee's budget. The more the tournament grows, the more families and players want the photos, reels, and prints. BJ's upside is tied to the tournament's growth, which he's also building. That alignment is the whole point.

What scales (and what's the floor)

- **Floor (predictable):** production fee (1) + builder retainer (5). Covers the trip and the time. Set with the committee.
- **Upside (scales with the crowd):** photo sales (2) + video packages (3) + prints/licensing (6). The bigger and more national the field, the more recruiting-age players whose families buy.
- **Sponsor-funded (scales with sponsorship):** premium sponsor media (4), ties to the sponsor tiers.

A realistic way to start eating (phased)

Year 1 (2026): lock the production fee + builder retainer (the floor). Run photo sales (digital packages, easy) and at least the championship recap video. Capture everything to the archive so nothing is left on the table.

Year 2: add video packages (player highlight reels are the high-margin, high-demand line for recruiting-age kids), formalize sponsor media add-ons, introduce championship prints/posters.

Year 3+: licensing, the print program book with ad sales, and extending the operation year-round (Vanguard's season + other local programs, since the relationships and gear are already there).

Pricing posture (BJ sets the numbers)

- The production fee is set with the committee (covers cost + the trip, not pure profit).
- Consumer lines (photos, video, prints) are priced like sports-media packages, accessible enough that families buy, premium enough that the work is respected.
- Sponsor media rides the sponsor tiers (see `KOTS_SPONSOR_MEDIA_DELIVERABLES.md`), premium features are an upsell.
- Exact numbers are deliberately not fixed here. This is the architecture; BJ prices it.

The one-line strategy

Don't sell a photographer. Run a media operation with a floor (fee + retainer) and an upside that grows as the tournament grows (photos, video, prints, licensing). Build the event bigger, eat bigger. Same hand on both.